slackened, innumerable questions arose in the minds of some people, and it was extraordinarily difficult to find answers to them. These questions did not affect the immediate course that had to be followed in politics. Rather they dealt with the whole philosophy that lay behind this idea of non-violent resistance. In a political sense the non-violent movement has not succeeded so far, for India is still held in the vice-like grip of imperialism. In a social sense it has not even envisaged a radical change. And yet any one with the slightest penetration can see that it has worked a remarkable change in India's millions. It has given them character, strength and self-reliance—precious gifts without which any progress, political or social, is difficult to achieve or to retain. How far these undoubted gains are due to non-violence or to the fact of conflict itself, it is difficult to say. Such gains have been achieved by various peoples on numerous occasions through violent conflict. Yet it may be said, I think with confidence, that the non-violent method has been of inestimable value to us in this respect. It has definitely helped in raising that 'ferment in society' to which Gandhiji refers, though undoubtedly that ferment was due to basic causes and conditions. It has brought about that quickening process in the masses that precedes revolutionary change.

That is an obvious point in its favour, but it does not carry us far. The real questions remain unanswered. Unfortunately Gandhiji does not help us much in solving the problem. He has written and spoken on innumerable occasions on the subject, but, so far as I know, he has never considered in public all its implications, philosophically or scientifically.[1] He lays stress on the means being more important than the end, of conversion being better than coercion, and there is a tendency to identify non-violence with truth and all goodness. Indeed he often uses the terms as if they were synonymous. There is also the tendency to consider all those who may not agree with this as outside the pale of the elect and as having offended against the moral law. In the case of some of his followers this translates itself inevitably into a feeling of self-righteousness.

Those of us who are not fortunate enough to have this faith are, however, troubled with a host of doubts. These doubts do not relate so much to immediate necessities, but to the mind's desire for some consistent philosophy of action which is both moral from the individual view-point and is at the same

[1] Richard B. Gregg in his *The Power of Non-Violence* has discussed the subject scientifically. His book is most interesting and thought-provoking.